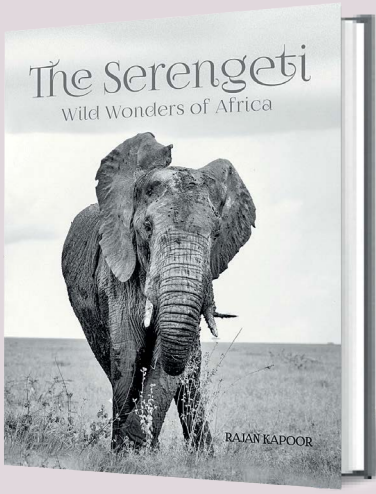
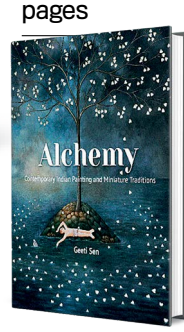


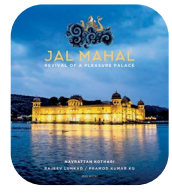
THE SERENGETI:
Wild Wonders of Africa
By Rajan Kapoor
NIYOGI BOOKS
₹4,500; 260 pages

The Serengeti: Wild Wonders of Africa **is a pictorial journey into some of the earth's most iconic and untamed landscapes. Here we witness the great dance of survival between predator and prey play out across vast, undulating plains. Little wonder that the word 'Siringit' in the language of the Maasai refers to 'a place where the land runs forever.' One couldn't imagine a better place on earth for the annual spectacle that is the Great Migration. I like the book because, without travelling there, it lets you experience a world of wonder in which every link is essential in the circle of life.**

ALCHEMY
Contemporary Indian Painting and Miniature Traditions
By Geeti Sen
MAPIN **₹1,500; 148** pages



Alchemy, Geeti Sen's unusual book published by Mapin, undersells itself at first glance because it seems like an exhibition catalogue. But just as well, because it makes up with the author's *raffinement* in sifting out the irrelevant to make precise interconnections between miniature paintings and the five protagonists she chooses. While Abanindranath Tagore, who emerged from the tail end of the 19th century, kept his painting format small, Manjit Bawa, Waswo X. Waswo with Rakesh Vijayvargiya, and Nilima Sheikh, expanded the miniatures beyond their earlier hand-held scope as manuscript illustrations.



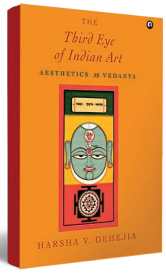
JAL MAHAL
Revival of a Pleasure Palace
By Navrattan Kothari, Rajeev Lunkad & Pramod Kumar K.G.
ROLI BOOKS
₹2,995; 224 pages

Jal Mahal, **authored by patron Navrattan Kothari, architect Rajeev Lunkad and the cultural advisor Pramod Kumar K.G., showcases a charmed 'listed' monument of Jaipur now made better than it ever was! This was built to please the Udaipur princess whom the founder of Jaipur had married, and it post-dates the Rani Sisodia Garden which didn't quite have the expanse to evoke the Jag Mandir on the Pichola Lake of Udaipur.**



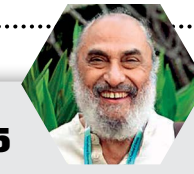
ICONIC
Masterpieces of Indian Modern Art, Edition 4
Edited by Kishore Singh
DAG **₹8,000; 436** pages

Iconic Masterpieces of Indian Modern Art, **Edition 4, published by DAG, could thump a billiard table with its 3.5 kg heirloom manufacture. It is a part of the richly curated volumes that celebrate the evolving legacy of Indian art through the centuries. By bridging the pre-modern and modern eras, this highlights the seamless continuity in India's artistic narrative.**



THE THIRD EYE OF INDIAN ART
Aesthetics as Vedanta
by Harsha V. Dehejia
ALEPH
₹499; 240 pages

Harsha V. Dehejia's *The Third Eye of Indian Art*, published by Aleph, manifests the wisdom of linking the created with the Creator. What two Indian eyes see, the third one can perceive far beyond. While this elixir of a book seems like a small peg, but being the distillation of several Vedantic wisdoms, it is more of a vodka shot! Perhaps our Indic-doctor of medicine in Canada now plays more with the powers beyond life. This gives him the strength and humility to own up to the intuitive inheritance of his genes and 'temper *jnana* [knowledge] with *bhakti* [devotion]', hoping that the third eye opens to become a trinity: *satyam*, *sundaram*, *samaranam*—truth, beauty, remembrance. This quiet little whisper of a book is worth its wisdom in gold.



2025

Two great photo-books by the unrivalled naturalist Rajesh Bedi are in the offing for early 2025. One is *City of Shiva: Varanasi*, which is simultaneously asleep and awake, and the other: *Indian Elephant: The Divine Mystery*, on the adorable, lumbering, pachyderm made playful or monolithic like Pirandello's animal. Both will surely delight connoisseurs.